

10 JOBS



If you have no problems at your job, you don't have a job, you've got a hobby.

Ronald Dunn

Doing nothing is the most tiresome job in the world because you cannot quit and rest.

Author Unknown

□ VOCABULARY INPUT

Dealing with this topic you will come across the following vocabulary. Read it and look up the unknown words in your dictionary.

- **physical and intellectual work:**

- hairdresser, barber, carpenter, bricklayer, butcher, baker, mechanic, shop assistant, plumber, cleaner
- banker, clerk, teacher, university lecturer, scientist, doctor, architect, journalist, psychoanalyst, interpreter, translator, sales representative, lawyer, attorney, artist, musician, accountant, surgeon, politician, mayor

- **employment:**

- to take on, to take up a post, to employ sb., to hire sb., to search for..., to hunt for...
- employer, employee, unemployed/jobless, self-employed, volunteer, long-term/permanent contract, short-term/temporary contract, part-time job, full-time job, freelance, seasonal jobs, casual job

- **schedules:**

- 35-hour working week, eight-hour working day, work from 9 to 5, overtime, flexitime, shift work, night shift, doing flexitime, telecommuting (telework)

- **hiring:**

- advertisement, application, background check, drug testing, job-hunting, probation, personnel department, personnel selection, employment counsellor, curriculum vitae (CV), motivation/cover letter (job application), references, interview, overqualified, recruiter, recruitment

- **job termination:**

- dismissal, letter of resignation, layoff, suspension, permanent termination of employment, retirement, early retirement, pensioner, pension, to quit, to resign, to get the sack

- **unemployment:**

- voluntary, involuntary, jobless, to be made redundant, to be dismissed, to be fired, to be sacked, job agency, unemployment benefits (the dole)

- **factors when searching for a job:**

- working hours, possible promotion, career development, travel opportunities, place of work, commuting, further education and training, career vs. family life, tempting offer, benefits

- **benefits:**

- pay (salary, wages, income, pay rise, sick pay), medical benefits, vacation days, annual leave, health insurance, life insurance, parental leave, sick leave, unemployment benefit, bonus, perk

- **qualities and skills:**

- reliability, flexibility, responsibility, motivation, experience, communication skills, management skills, problem solving, dealing with complaints, creativity, team-building, following the latest trends, driving skills, patience, speaking a foreign language

- **responsibilities and duties:**

- to be responsible for, to deal with, to handle, to be in charge of, to involve, to control, to check, to manage, to supervise, to advise, to treat, to look after, to communicate in person, to run your own business, to set up/establish/found a company

- **career vs. family life:**

- workaholic, maternity leave, maternity pay, working mothers, to be under pressure

□ DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

Before reading the text, discuss the following questions in class.

1. Which jobs are typically done by men/women in your country?
2. Which job did you want to do when you were a child?
3. What kind of job would you like to get in the future?
4. How important is education if someone wants to get a good job?
5. What do people need to do to get a good job?
6. Which jobs do you think are the best/worst paid in your country?
7. Are people in your country prone to become workaholics?
8. What steps should people take when they look for a job?
9. Why do people become unemployed?
10. Does government in your country support the unemployed? How?

□ TEXT

Read the texts below in silence. Check the meaning of the words in bold and answer the questions below.

ECONOMICALLY ACTIVE AND INACTIVE POPULATION

Work (or our **occupation**) plays an important role in our lives. This way we do not only **earn** money but also find our place in society, spend time with other people and feel useful. The economically active population **includes** people who **are willing** and **able to work** and people who **search for** work – **the unemployed**. The first group includes **self-employed** people and **employees**. The economically inactive people are **minors**, **the retired**, **the disabled**, **the sick** or those who do not wish or are **unable to work**.

When a child is born to a couple, it is usually the mother who takes **maternity leave**. In Slovakia, it normally takes three years. **Maternity pay** is not very high in our country, so the man is very often responsible for earning the **entire** family **income**. Later, when the child grows a little and is able to attend a **nursery school**, the mother often goes back to work. She has the responsibility for **childcare** and the household, so flexible working hours are very **convenient** for her. Many families cannot **afford** this, so women often continue working full-time and take care of the child and the household too. It is very difficult for every woman to have both a good family life and a successful career.

1. Which parts of the population are economically active and inactive?
2. How is the role of mothers with small children described in the text above with reference to job opportunities?

PHYSICAL AND INTELLECTUAL WORK

It is not easy to choose the right profession, especially at a young age. It is very important to have a profession that suits us and that we like. We have to **consider** several factors, such as the type of work, possible **promotion** and career development, salary, working time, **commuting**, travel opportunities and place of work amongst others. We basically **differentiate** between physical and intellectual work. Physical work **requires** physical **strength** and **persistence**. Most manual workers work in **manufacturing** or construct buildings. There are many different types of intellectual work. Some professions require detailed **knowledge** (e.g. scientists, doctors, **lawyers**, **accountants**), others talent and creativity (e.g. artists). There are more and more professions that require communication and organisation skills, such as **public relations** managers, **interpreters**, teachers, **psychoanalysts**, **sales representatives** and others. In most professions nowadays, it is important to follow the latest trends. If people want to “stay in”, they have to develop their skills and keep informed. Therefore, they often **participate in** different post-graduate study programmes, go on training courses and attend different workshops, seminars and conferences. In some occupations, people have **responsibility** for other peoples’ lives (e.g. doctors, pilots, drivers...). Some professions can be very dangerous. If you are a policeman, a pilot, a construction worker or a **truck driver** for example, there is a high risk of you being injured or being hurt in an accident.

3. Give some examples of jobs requiring physical and intellectual work.
4. What are the qualities and skills usually required for doing physical and intellectual work?

APPLYING FOR A JOB

Employment is a contract between an employer and an employee. The employer is a person or an institution which **hires** employees. In larger organisations **personnel selection** is organised by the *Human Resources Department*. Job **vacancies** are usually advertised in newspapers or on the Internet. Candidates send in their job **applications** and their **CVs**, together with a letter of motivation. Their CV should include personal data and details about their education, skills and work experience. Those who are selected are invited to an interview. At an interview they usually answer questions, describe their motivation and **expectations**. It is important for the candidates to prepare for the interview, to find information about the organisation or the company, to answer clearly and to stay calm. If a candidate **succeeds**, he or she is given an official **offer** of employment with a **defined starting salary**, position, **medical benefits** and **vacation days**. Most jobs give 4–6 weeks’ paid holiday and **sick pay** for when employees are ill. Employees can be hired **to work full-time** or **part-time**. Some only have **fixed-term contracts**. They earn **wages** paid according to the number of hours, days or weeks that they work or a salary paid every month. It is important to differentiate between a salary **before tax** and **after tax**. It is usually low at the beginning of a career, but it increases with the **professional growth** and **progress** of the employees. Many people are self-employed and **run their own businesses**. They can, but do not have to, employ other people. People who are

paid neither wages nor **salaries** are called **volunteers** – they usually **work for free** in regions at war or regions hit by natural catastrophes.

5. What is employment according to the text above?
6. Referring to the text, what information should a CV and a motivation letter include?

WORKING SCHEDULES

The **working time** in Europe **varies** between 33 and 41 hours a week. In Slovakia, in most professions, the working time is 40 hours a week (8 hours a day). However, there are more and more professions where people work long hours. "**Shift work**" describes regular employment outside normal daytime hours and is typical for the **healthcare** service (doctors, nurses), **the emergency services** (e. g. **emergency** medical services, police and **fire-fighters**) and production and transportation (e. g. **machine operators**, **truck drivers**). In our country, people **in general**, start work at 8.00 in the morning and finish at about 5 p.m. They normally have a **lunch break** at lunch time. Some people have **flexible working hours**, which means they can work at different times. New technologies, especially the Internet, have enabled people to work from home. This is called **teleworking**. **Although** employers can **reduce** their **costs** this way, working from home is still not very **common** in our country.

7. Which professions require people to work in shifts and which ones enable people to work flexitime?
8. What is "teleworking"? What do you think are the advantages and disadvantages of teleworking for an employee?

LABOUR MARKET

The **labour market** in our country has changed in the last decade. More work opportunities have been created thanks to foreign investors coming to the country to **set up** their companies here. A lot of people had to complete their education or **retrain**. However, some fields still **lack a qualified labour force**, such as for **mechanical engineering** or in the building industry. The global financial crisis has increased unemployment; many people are **being fired** or **being made redundant**. In every society, there are people who are not willing to work and never will be. They **benefit** from the **social security system** – they are **on the dole**. They often work illegally or are **supported** by somebody else. After reaching a certain age, people **retire**. Men and women retire at different ages. The retirement age of women depends on the number of children she has. Sometimes, people take early **retirement**.

9. What are common reasons for people being unemployed according to the text above?
10. What is the retirement age for men and women in your country?

□ VOCABULARY LIST

accountant [ə'kauntənt] – účtovník
to afford [ə'fɔ:d] – dovoliť si
after tax – po zdanení
application – prihláška
before tax – pred zdanením
to benefit – ťažiť z niečoho
childcare – starostlivosť o dieťa
commuting [kəm'ju:tiŋ] – dochádzanie
to consider – zvážiť (si)
convenient [kən'vi:niənt] – výhodný
costs – náklady
CV (curriculum vitae) – životopis
defined starting salary – stanovený nástupný plat
to differentiate – rozlišovať
to earn – zarobiť
emergency service – pohotovostná služba
to employ – zamestnať
employee [im'plɔɪ] – zamestnanec
employer [im'plɔɪə(r)] – zamestnávateľ
employment – zamestnanosť
entire [in'taɪə(r)] – celý, kompletný
expectation – očakávanie
fire-fighter – hasič
fixed-term contract – zmluva na dobu určitú
flexible working hours – flexibilný pracovný čas
to hire [haɪə(r)] – najať si
income [ɪnkʌm, also ɪnkəm] – príjem
interpreter [ɪntɜ:pɪtə(r)] – tlmočník
job vacancy – voľné pracovné miesto
knowledge – vedomosti
labour market – trh práce
lawyer [lɔ:jə(r)] – právnik
manufacturing [mænjʊfæktʃərɪŋ] – výroba
maternity leave – materská dovolenka
maternity pay – materský príspevok
mechanical engineering – strojárstvo
medical benefit – liečebná starostlivosť
minor [maɪnə(r)] – nepľnoletý
nursery school – materská škôlka
occupation – povolanie, zamestnanie
offer – ponuka
to participate in – zúčastniť sa
persistence – vytrvalosť
personnel selection – výber personálu
professional growth – profesionálny rast
progress – pokrok
promotion – povýšenie

psychoanalalyst [saɪkəʊ'ænəlist] – psychoanalytik
public relations – styk s verejnosťou
to reduce – znížiť
to require [rɪkwaɪə] – vyžadovať
to retire – odísť do dôchodku
retirement – dôchodok
responsibility – zodpovednosť
to retrain – preškoliť sa, rekvalifikovať sa
salary – plat
sales representative – obchodný zástupca
to search for – hľadať
self-employed – samostatne zárobkovo činný
to set up – založiť
sick pay – nemocenská
shift work – práca na zmeny
social security system – systém sociálneho zabezpečenia
strength – sila
to succeed [sək'sɪd] – uspieť
to support – podporovať
teleworking – práca z domu
the disabled – postihnutí
the retired – dôchodci
the sick – chorí
the unemployed – nezamestnaní
truck driver – vodič kamiónu
vacation day – voľný deň (dovolenka)
to vary [veəri] – rôzniť sa
volunteer [vɒləntɪə(r)] – dobrovoľník
wage [weɪdʒ] – mzda

to be fired – byť vyhodnený
to be made redundant – byť nadbytočný
to be on the dole (BrE) – byť na podpore
to be (un)able to work – byť (ne)schopný pracovať
to be willing to do – byť ochotný urobiť
Human Resources Department – oddelenie ľudských zdrojov
to lack a qualified labour force – postrádať kvalifikovanú pracovnú silu
to run one's own business – podnikáť
to work full-time – pracovať na plný úväzok
to work part-time – pracovať na čiastočný úväzok

□ VOCABULARY PRACTICE

Task 1 Who...?



Which jobs are described below?

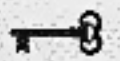
1. catches criminals _____
2. serves you in a restaurant _____
3. takes photographs _____
4. fixes taps and leaking pipes _____
5. does the bookkeeping _____
6. represents a town/city after being elected by its inhabitants for a fixed period

7. offers/sells property _____
8. writes in newspapers _____
9. works in a library _____
10. cuts women's hair _____
11. cuts men's hair and shaves them _____
12. advises people with legal problems _____
13. repairs cars _____
14. makes things with wood _____
15. designs and plans where roads and bridges will be built _____

Task 2 Which jobs described above are physical and which are intellectual?

Which of them do you find the most interesting, the least interesting, the most dangerous, the worst paid and the best paid? Which qualities/skills are needed to do those jobs? Choose from the list below.

flexibility – working in shifts – being in danger – creativity – physical strength
– communication skills – organisation skills – responsibility – good social
behaviour – decision making – problem solving – good imagination – reliability
– writing skills – a good memory – patience – speaking a foreign language –
a feeling for beauty – good driving skills – professional knowledge – working
in a team – following the latest trends

Task 3 At an Interview

Match the interviewer's questions with the candidate's answers.

What job/position is the candidate probably applying for?

What are the "taboo" questions interviewers should not ask at an interview?

Example: Do you speak any foreign languages? Yes, I do. I speak English and French.

Interviewer's questions:

1. Why are you interested in this job?
2. What are your expectations?
3. What experience do you have in this field?
4. Why did you quit your previous job?
5. What kind of education do you have?
6. Do you have any references?
7. What are your strengths?
8. What are your weaknesses?
9. Would you like to ask anything?
10. What do you know about our company?

Candidate's answers:

- ☐ A) I worked for 5 years for a car company.
- ☐ B) I would like to know more about the working hours.
- ☐ C) I am responsible and hardworking.
- ☐ D) It looks like there is a lot of creativity in it.
- ☐ E) Possible promotion and travel opportunities.
- ☐ F) I attended secondary technical school.
- ☐ G) I am prone to overworking.
- ☐ H) You're a French company which produces cars.
- ☐ I) I had to work at weekends.
- ☐ J) Yes, of course. I have one from my previous employer.